

Backstage Mechanism



Latent variables

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Chameleon - Composition



Latent variables



Noise on data is not the only stochastic phenomenon. Internal random switches in the model or the results of hidden processes are never observed. They form latent variables, whose posterior distribution is sought.



latent states, unobserved causes, hidden structure, probabilistic encoding, noise modeling



Condenses unknown effects into hidden states; reconciles contradictory observations.



Latent distributions hide structural flaws; randomness becomes an excuse.



Assume the target card has a hidden random state; is it epistemic or aleatoric?



"Where have you swept unexplained behavior into a latent variable?"



The audience marveled at sets that shifted with no visible cause. Only the stagehands knew of the counterweights in the rafters. Over time, anything unexplained was attributed to "the ropes".

